

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2013

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard
Retrieved	8 August 2026
Records	21 House, 18 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. Amendment to Provide Additional Support for Superstorm Sandy Recovery

H.Amdt.5 to H.R. 152 · January 15, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 228 NAYs 192

Superstorm Sandy ravaged the East Coast in November 2012. While the Senate passed a relief bill in December, House Speaker John Boehner (R-OH) cancelled a vote on the Senate bill. Finally in late January Boehner brought a disaster relief bill to the floor. Rep. Rodney Frelinghuysen (R-N.J.) offered an amendment that added \$33.7 billion to the bill for long-term recovery and mitigation spending to address the storm damage. The amendment was approved.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-provide-additional-support-superstorm-sandy-recovery>

2. Supplemental Appropriations for FY2013 for Superstorm Sandy Recovery

H.R. 152 · January 15, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 241 NAYs 180

The Superstorm Sandy relief bill provided more than \$50 billion for communities hit by the storm. Most of the funds were to rebuild the homes and businesses destroyed by the storm, including funding for rebuilding and improving the transportation systems or help for flood control and shore strengthening projects to lessen the impact of future storms. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/supplemental-appropriations-fy2013-superstorm-sandy-recovery>

3. Amendment to Follow the Simpson-Bowles Budget Recommendations

H.R. 444 · February 6, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 75 NAYs 348

Rep. Kurt Schrader (D-Ore.) introduced an amendment to a budget-related bill (H.R. 444) that directed President Obama to follow the budget recommendations of the Simpson-Bowles commission. Those recommendations included cuts to Social Security benefits, shifting Medicare costs to beneficiaries, lower tax rates for the wealthy and corporations and increased tax incentives for shipping jobs overseas. The amendment was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-follow-simpson-bowles-budget-recommendations>

4. Appropriations Amendment Freezing Federal Employee Pay

H.R. 273 · February 15, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 261 NAYs 154

Federal workers' pay was frozen in 2011 and 2012. H.R. 273 extended that pay freeze through 2013. In addition to the pay freeze, federal workers have faced sequester furloughs and other arbitrary cuts. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/appropriations-amendment-freezing-federal-employee-pay>

5. Motion to Recommit: Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act

H.R. 803 · March 15, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 184 NAYs 233

While the Republican bill would reauthorize the Workforce Investment Act (WIA), it also would consolidate 35 employment and training programs into a single funding stream for state and local use and eliminate some services among many changes to WIA. Rep. George Miller (D-Calif.) offered a motion to recommit the bill with an amendment that would clarify that nothing in the bill would repeal, deny or loosen employment protections, training opportunities or educational benefits for certain seniors, veterans, women or youth. The amendment also would also increase the federal minimum wage to \$10.10 within two years of the bill's enactment. The measure was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/motion-recommit-workforce-innovation-and-opportunity-act>

6. Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act

H.R. 803 · March 15, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 215 NAYs 202

While the Republican bill would reauthorize the Workforce Investment Act (WIA), it also would consolidate 35 employment and training programs into a single funding stream for state and local use and eliminate some services. The bill also contained provisions to reduce the amount of labor representation on the Workforce Development Boards. Further, it contained mechanisms requiring that the authorization for WIA job training be reduced by at least 10 percent. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/workforce-innovation-and-opportunity-act>

7. FY2014 Budget Resolution

H.Con.Res. 25 · March 21, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 221 NAYs 207

Rep. Paul Ryan (R-Wisc.) authored a budget plan that would have required deep sacrifices by middle class working families, senior citizens and other vulnerable Americans, while providing additional tax cuts to corporations and the rich. The Ryan budget plan would have made large cuts in Medicaid, ended Medicare as we know it by converting it into a voucher program, and would have repealed the Affordable Care Act. It was estimated the plan could give tax cuts as high as an average of \$330,000 for households with incomes of more than \$1 million a year and for households with incomes more than \$200,000, the tax cut would be nearly \$34,500. Families with children and incomes under \$200,000 would likely have seen their taxes go up by an average of more than \$3,000 under the Ryan plan. In addition, it would have required deep cuts to job training, education, food, housing, legal services and advanced technology vehicles manufacturing programs. The budget resolution passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/fy2014-budget-resolution>

8. Preventing Greater Uncertainty in Labor-Management Relations Act

H.R. 1120 · April 12, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 209

Congressional Republicans have engaged in a years-long battle to cripple the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB), including blocking NLRB nominations, legislation to de-fund the board, and curtail its work. H.R. 1120 would effectively shut down the NLRB and needlessly place the rights of millions of American workers in jeopardy. The NLRB is the one agency workers whose rights have been violated can turn to for relief. The NLRB remedies unfair labor practices and defends the right of employees to join a union and bargain collectively with their employers. Shutting the NLRB down would leave employees with no place to go to ensure their rights under the law are enforced. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/preventing-greater-uncertainty-labor-management-relations-act>

9. Working Families Flexibility Act of 2013

H.R. 1406 · May 8, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 223 NAYs 204

The wrongly named bill was all about flexibility for employers, not employees. The bill would allow employers to provide workers with compensatory time off in lieu of time and half overtime pay. The 'comp time' could only be used at the employer's discretion and the bill provides no protection for workers who would rather be paid overtime instead of comp time from employer discrimination or for workers whose employers cheat them out of earned comp time. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/working-families-flexibility-act-2013>

10. Repeal of the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act

H.R. 45 · May 16, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 229 NAYs 195

Though the U.S. Supreme Court ruled that the Affordable Care Act (ACA) was constitutional, House Republicans have held dozens of votes repeal the health care reform law. The ACA improves access to affordable health care coverage, provides consumer protections, and reduces the federal deficit. If repealed, 1.2 million young adults would lose their coverage through their parents' health plan; 2.7 million seniors would pay higher prices for

prescription drugs; 44 million seniors would be denied free preventive services; and insurance companies would be allowed to resume denying coverage, limiting care and spending premiums on larger CEO salaries and profits. This version of the repeal passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/repeal-patient-protection-and-affordable-care-act>

11. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

H.Amdt. 96 to H.R. 2216 · June 4, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 192 NAYs 231

This amendment by Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) to the Military Construction and Veterans Affairs Appropriation Act, 2014 (H.R. 2216) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws>

12. Amendment to Defund Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals

H.Amdt. 136 to H.R. 2217 · June 6, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 224 NAYs 201

In 2012, the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) implemented Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA), a directive that provides a temporary stay of removal and work authorization for young immigrants who were brought to the United States by their parents as children and would qualify for the DREAM Act. During consideration of the DHS appropriations bill Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) offered an amendment that would bar the use of funds provided in the bill to implement or enforce DACA and expose DREAMers to deportation. The amendment was approved.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-defund-deferred-action-childhood-arrivals>

13. Amendment to Encourage the Outsourcing of Department of Defense Jobs

H.R. 1960 · June 13, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 178 NAYs 248

An amendment to FY 2014 Defense Authorization Act by Rep. Scott Rigell (R-Va.) would have lifted the long-standing ban on outsourcing Department of Defense (DoD) jobs under a process known as A-76. Congress originally imposed a government-wide moratorium on the use of the A-76 process because of long-standing problems identified by the DoD Inspector General and the Government Accountability Office in DoD's annual \$200 billion in contracting that have not been corrected. The amendment was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-encourage-outsourcing-department-defense-jobs>

14. Amendment to Defund the Food for Peace Program

H.Amdt. 190 to H.R. 1947 · June 19, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 203 NAYs 220

For nearly 60 years, Food for Peace has been the United States' principle international food assistance program and has fed billions of needy people around the globe. During consideration of the Federal Agriculture Reform and Risk Management (FARRM) Act, Rep. Ed Royce (R-Calif.) offered an amendment that would have gutted the Food for Peace program and in the process jeopardized the U.S. maritime industry and the workforce that helps deliver aid around the world. The amendment failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/amendment-defund-food-peace-program>

15. Student Success Act

H.R. 5 · July 19, 2013

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 221 NAYs 207

The so-called Student Success Act would reauthorize the nation's elementary and secondary education law through 2019. But the Republican bill starves schools of resources and does nothing to address what educators say is pervasive over testing of students. With nearly half of all children in public schools living in poverty, the bill diverts resources for poor children—resources already cut by the sequester—to programs and policies that do not have a track record of success and are based on ideology, not results. It also undercuts the ability of school districts to target and increase funds to schools serving the highest concentrations of poor students. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/student-success-act>

16. REINS Act of 2013

H.R. 367 · August 2, 2013
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 232 NAYs 183

The so-called REINS Act would cripple government's ability to develop new health, safety and environmental laws. The REINS Act would basically take away the right of federal safety and health agencies to implement new rules by requiring Congress to approve all individual major rules, without Congressional approval the new rule would die. Politics, not scientific judgments or expertise of the agencies, would dictate action while corporate opposition and influence would swamp the public's interest and block needed protections. Part of the Republicans' so-called 'jobs' plan, this legislation would undermine key public health and worker protections and seriously disrupt federal services. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/reins-act-2013>

17. Nutrition Reform and Work Opportunity Act of 2015

H.R. 3102 · September 19, 2013
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 210

After failing to pass a complete farm bill in the House, the Republican leadership passed a separate bill on the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)'s food stamps. The bill was the Republican plan to overhaul the nation's largest food aid program. It cuts \$40 billion in food aid to families in need over the next 10 years. It would also reduce states' flexibility on waivers and increase the requirements to automatically qualify. These cuts would affect a broad array of Americans who are struggling to make ends meet, including working families with children, senior citizens, veterans and adults who are still looking for work. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/nutrition-reform-and-work-opportunity-act-2015>

18. Continuing Appropriations Resolution, 2014

H.J.Res. 59 · September 29, 2013
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 231 NAYs 192

As the shutdown of the federal government loomed at the end of September, the Tea Party Republicans put forth a continuing resolution to fund the government in an effort to force the Senate and administration to roll back the implementation of the Affordable Care Act until 2015. This bill was not a clean spending bill to keep the government open, but was instead a politically motivated bill that led to the disastrous 16-day federal government shut down. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/continuing-appropriations-resolution-2014>

19. Continuing Appropriations Act, 2014

H.R. 2775 · October 16, 2013
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 285 NAYs 144

This bill ended the 16-day Republican-led government shutdown that kept vital services behind locked doors for the public, paychecks out of the pockets of hundreds of thousands of federal workers, and pushed the economy to the brink of disaster. The Fiscal 2014 Continuing Appropriations and Debt Limit Suspension bill funds government operations through Jan. 15, 2014, and raises the debt ceiling to allow federal borrowing through Feb. 7, 2014. It also would provide for retroactive pay for federal employees who worked or were furloughed during that time. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/continuing-appropriations-act-2014>

20. Water Resources Reform and Development Act of 2014

H.R. 3080 · October 23, 2013
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 417 NAYs 3

The bill authorizes the Army Corps of Engineers projects, including dredging harbors and protecting waterways from storm damage. It would also modernize locks and dams, provide upkeep for rivers and assist with flood protection. The bill also would expedite the environmental permitting process for water projects. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/water-resources-reform-and-development-act-2014>

21. Retail Investor Protection Act

	H.R. 2374 · October 29, 2013
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 254 NAYs 166
	With the decline in traditional pensions, American workers are increasingly dependent on individual retirement savings accounts, like 401(k) accounts and Individual Retirement Accounts (IRAs), for their income in retirement. The misnamed 'Retail Investor Protection Act' would prevent the Department of Labor and the Security and Exchange Commission from modernizing outdated rules so that financial advisors are prohibited from engaging in deceptive practices or conflicts of interest when they provide investment advice regarding individual retirement accounts. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/house/retail-investor-protection-act

SENATE

1. Supplemental Appropriations for FY2013 for Superstorm Sandy Recovery

	H.R. 152 · January 28, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 62 NAYs 36
	Superstorm Sandy ravaged the East Coast in November 2012. While the Senate passed a relief bill in December, House Speaker John Boehner (R-Ohio) cancelled a vote on the Senate bill. Finally in late January the House passed a disaster relief bill (H.R. 152). It provided more than \$50 billion for communities hit by Sandy. Most of the funds were to rebuild the homes and businesses destroyed by the storm, including funding for rebuilding and improving the transportation systems or help for flood control and shore strengthening projects. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/supplemental-appropriations-fy2013-superstorm-sandy-recovery

2. Confirmation of Caitlin J. Halligan to the U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals

	March 6, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 51 NAYs 41
	During the past several years Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on several of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts and many judicial nominations. One of those nominations was Obama's choice of Caitlin J. Halligan to be a judge for the U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia. A motion to invoke cloture (which requires 60 votes) and end the filibuster against Halligan failed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-caitlin-j-halligan-us-circuit-court-appeals

3. Marketplace Fairness Act of 2013

	S. 743 · May 6, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 69 NAYs 27
	The bill grants states the authority to require remote sellers (out of state internet and mail order) to collect sales tax. It's estimated that states and localities lose as much as \$23 billion a year in uncollected tax revenue on internet sales. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/marketplace-fairness-act-2013

4. Amendment to Include Buy American Provisions

	S. Amdt. 866 to S. 601 · May 15, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 60 NAYs 36
	Sen. Jeff Merkley (D-Ore.) offered an amendment to the Water Resources Development Act Reauthorization to require the use of American iron, steel and manufactured goods for projects funded by the bill. Buy American provisions help create American jobs, especially in the manufacturing sector. The amendment allowed some exemptions, such as if those materials are not available or would increase the cost of the project by more than 25 percent. The amendment passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/amendment-include-buy-american-provisions

5. Water Resources Development Act of 2013

	S. 601 · May 15, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 83 NAYs 14
	The bill authorizes the Army Corps of Engineers projects, including dredging harbors and protecting waterways from storm damage. It would also modernize locks and dams, provide upkeep for rivers and assist with flood protection. It would also create national levee safety program. The bill also sets a 10-year sunset date on provisions that would expedite the environmental permitting process for water projects. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/water-resources-development-act-2013

6. Amendment to Limit Border Security Contractor Pay

	S.Amdt. 1268 to S. 744 · June 19, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 72 NAYs 26
	A study by the Government Accountability Office (GAO) on excessive pay for federal contractors found that if all federal contractor pay was capped at the same salary that the Vice President of the United States earns (\$230,700) it would save the nation at least \$50 billion over the next decade. An amendment by Senator Joe Manchin (D-W.Va.) to the Border Security, Economic Opportunity, and Immigration Modernization Act (S. 744) limited private contractor abuse by capping federal border security contractors' compensation to no more than the vice president's. The amendment was approved.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/amendment-limit-border-security-contractor-pay

7. Border Security, Economic Opportunity, and Immigration Modernization Act

	S. 744 · June 27, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 68 NAYs 32
	The bill provides a roadmap to citizenship for millions of aspiring citizens currently living and working in the U.S. and a new employment-based visa program (the W Visa) for lesser skilled, non-seasonal, and non-agricultural workers that reflects a blueprint developed by the AFL-CIO and the U.S. Chamber of Commerce. The new visa program will not keep workers in a permanent temporary status and provides workers the chance to leave abusive employers. It also allows workers to self-petition for a path to citizenship and it automatically adjusts as the American economy expands and contracts. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/border-security-economic-opportunity-and-immigration-modernization-act

8. Confirmation of Richard Cordray for Consumer Financial Protection Bureau Secretary

	July 16, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 66 NAYs 34
	In 2011, President Obama nominated Richard Cordray to head the the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB), the agency created under the Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform bill to police non-bank financial institutions, including firms such as pay day lenders and mortgage companies that have histories of exploiting working people. But Republican obstructionist tactics blocked action on Cordray and other Obama nominations for almost two years. With Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters of executive branch nominees, Senate Republicans backed down and allowed as vote on the Cordray nomination. He was confirmed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-richard-cordray-consumer-financial-protection-bureau

9. Confirmation of Thomas E. Perez for Labor Secretary

	July 18, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 54 NAYs 46
	For the past several years, Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on many of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts. In July, with Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters on executive branch nominees, Republicans relented and agreed to allow votes on the nominees, including the nomination of Thomas E. Perez to be Labor Secretary. He was confirmed on July 18.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-thomas-e-perez-labor-secretary

10. Confirmation of Kent Hirozawa for the National Labor Relations Board

	July 30, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 54 NAYs 44
	For the past several years, Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on many of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts, including the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB) which would have been without a quorum and unable to function if new members were not confirmed by August. In July, with Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters on executive branch nominees, Republicans relented and agreed to allow votes on the nominees. Obama nominated Kent Yoshiho Hirozawa to be a member of the NLRB. He was confirmed on July 30.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-kent-hirozawa-national-labor-relations-board

11. Confirmation of Nancy Schiffer for the National Labor Relations Board

	July 30, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 54 NAYs 44
	For the past several years, Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on many of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts, including the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB) which would have been without a quorum and unable to function if new members were not confirmed by August. In July, with Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters on executive branch nominees, Republicans relented and agreed to allow votes on the nominees. Obama nominated Nancy Jean Schiffer to be a member of the NLRB. She was confirmed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-nancy-schiffer-national-labor-relations-board

12. Confirmation of Mark Pearce for the National Labor Relations Board

	July 30, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 59 NAYs 38
	For the past several years, Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on many of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts, including the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB) which would have been without a quorum and unable to function if new members were not confirmed by August. In July, with Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters on executive branch nominees, Republicans relented and agreed to allow votes on the nominees. Obama nominated Mark Gaston Pearce to be a member of the NLRB. He was confirmed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-mark-pearce-national-labor-relations-board

13. Continuing Appropriations Act, 2014

	H.R. 2775 · October 16, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 81 NAYs 18
	This bill ended the 16-day Republican-led government shutdown that kept vital services behind locked doors for the public, paychecks out of the pockets of hundreds of thousands of federal workers, and pushed the economy to the brink of disaster. The Fiscal 2014 Continuing Appropriations and Debt Limit Suspension bill funds government operations through Jan. 15, 2014, and raises the debt ceiling to allow federal borrowing through Feb. 7, 2014. It also would provide for retroactive pay for federal employees who worked or were furloughed during that time. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/continuing-appropriations-act-2014

14. Confirmation of Richard Griffin for National Labor Relations Board General Counsel

	October 29, 2013
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 55 NAYs 44
	For the past several years Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on several of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts and many judicial nominations. In July, with Senate Democrats on the verge of changing Senate rules to block filibusters on executive branch nominees, Republicans relented and agreed to allow votes on several nominees, including the nomination of Richard F. Griffin to be the General Counsel of the National Labor Relations Board. Griffin was confirmed by the Senate.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-richard-griffin-national-labor-relations-board-general

15. Employment Non-Discrimination Act of 2013

S. 815 · November 7, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 64 NAYs 32

The Employment Non-Discrimination Act (ENDA) would prohibit discrimination against employees or job applicants on the basis of their actual or perceived sexual orientation or gender identity. Currently 29 states allow workers to be fired for being gay and 33 allow workers to be fired from being transgendered. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/employment-non-discrimination-act-2013>

16. Senate Rules Change: Threshold for Cloture on Nominations to Simple Majority

November 21, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 52 NAYs 48

Responding to the Republican minority's unprecedented use of the filibuster to block Obama administration nominees from getting up or down votes, Majority Leader Harry Reid proposed an historic change in the rules of the Senate to allow a majority of Senators to cut off debate with 51 votes, instead of 60, during the consideration of all executive branch and judicial nominees. In the entire history of the Senate, there have been 168 filibusters of executive branch and judicial nominees; half of them occurred during the Obama administration. Further, only 23 district court nominees have been filibustered since the beginning of the Senate; 20 of them occurred during the past four and a half years. The rules change ending the minority party's stranglehold on the nominations process was passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/senate-rules-change-threshold-cloture-nominations-simple-majority>

17. Confirmation of Mel Watt for Federal Housing Finance Agency Director

December 10, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 57 NAYs 41

During the past several years Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on several of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts and many judicial nominations. One of those nominations was Obama's choice of Rep. Mel Watt (D-N.C.) to lead the Federal Housing Finance Agency (FHFA). The FHFA is the agency that oversees the mortgage finance companies Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac, which together guarantee nearly 80% of all mortgages nationwide. After the Senate rule change, Watt was confirmed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-mel-watt-federal-housing-finance-agency-director>

18. Confirmation of Cornelia Pillard for District of Columbia Circuit Judge

December 12, 2013

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 51 NAYs 44

During the past several years Senate Republicans engaged in obstruction tactics that blocked votes on several of President Obama's nominees for key cabinet and agency posts and many judicial nominations. One of those nominations was Obama's choice of Cornelia T. L. 'Nina' Pillard to be United States Circuit Judge for the District of Columbia Circuit. After the Senate rule change, Pillard was confirmed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2013/senate/confirmation-cornelia-pillard-district-columbia-circuit-judge>